

Academic Integrity Policy for Students

Introduction:

Academic integrity is a core value of all reputed educational institutions. SLIIT is therefore committed to maintaining the highest standards of academic integrity at all levels of the institution. SLIIT students must be informed of the expectations for academic integrity, practices and behaviours that violate academic integrity, and the process for addressing academic integrity violations, including the penalties. SLIIT expects all students to abide by this policy. Unacceptable non-academic actions by students shall be dealt with under other SLIIT policies and procedures.

SLIIT acknowledges the six fundamental values of academic integrity defined by the International Center for Academic Integrity (ICAI) (www.academicintegrity.org): honesty, trust, fairness, respect, responsibility, and courage. As stated by ICAI, "From these values flow principles of behavior that enable academic communities to translate ideals to action."

Violation of Academic Integrity:

Academic integrity violations usually occur due to plagiarism, collusion, cheating, unacceptable practices during assessments – both online and on-site – and other malpractices that create unfair advantages to a student or a group of students. The following general definitions are used for common categories of academic integrity violations.

Plagiarism involves presenting the work, findings, ideas or concepts belonging to others without full acknowledgment or as his/her original work. It is essential that in all academic work, including research, students ensure that materials (text, graphical objects, data, videos, etc.) taken from various sources, including print and digital, for written work and oral presentations are appropriately cited.

Collusion occurs when a student seeks unethical collaboration from peers to complete academic work (assignment, report, etc.). Authorized collaboration is an integral part of teaching and learning in a higher education environment and expected during projects and other academic work. Working in teams is a skill that students are expected to develop. However, students must exercise sound judgement when working in collaboration to ensure that they do not engage in collusion.

Cheating occurs when a student receives an unfair or unauthorized academic advantage through actions such as, but not limited to, engaging another person to do on his/her behalf or do on behalf of another SLIIT student an academic assessment (exam, assignment, lab, projects, etc.), using unauthorized materials during an assessment, using devices to access unauthorized information and/or communicate with others during examinations, copying from another student, doctoring data, stealing assessment materials, falsifying academic credentials, requesting breaks during an assessment to access unauthorized information, and forging medical certificates and other documents to gain advantage / accommodation.

Unacceptable actions during online assessments and other malpractices include, but not limited to, seeking and/or engaging unauthorized help from an individual or a group of individuals either in person or remotely, a website, an organization, or a device; impersonation during an online assessment; destroying, concealing and stealing library resources to gain an academic advantage; and hacking and accessing the information on examination servers and online Learning Management Systems for academic advantage. Forging a SLIIT officer's

signature and falsifying or misrepresenting the institution's official documents for an academic advantage are also breaches of academic integrity. These actions may be performed by a student or another person on behalf of a student.

Process for Managing Academic Integrity Violations:

Cases of academic integrity violation shall be promptly reported, investigated, and concluded to protect institutional credibility and commitment. The violations are often noted by module instructors and/or staff engaged in teaching and invigilating/marketing final examinations and continuous assessments. This policy also accommodates violations reported by students and staff not directly involved in the module. SLIIT recognizes the importance of confidentiality and following sound practices during investigations.

Extract from the Senate Paper 112.05.03

Schedule of Punishments:

A student who is found to be guilty of an academic misconduct is liable to be subjected to any one or a combination of the following punishments.

- Written warning
- Nullifying the results/ marks of the particular assessment in which the offence occurred.
- Nullifying the results/marks of all the assessments of the particular module examination where that the offence occurred.
- Nullifying the results/ marks of all the assessments of the particular module examination that the offence occurred and debarring the student from sitting the said module examination or equivalent module during the next two semesters / next academic year
- Nullifying the results/ marks of the all assessments of all the modules in the study semester/ year and debarring the student from taking any assessment for a specified period considering the scale of offences
- Suspension of studentship for a specified period considering the scale of offences.
- Termination of studentship

Extract from the Student Rule Book

Students can refer to their Faculty Examination Units and the Courseweb for more information.